

1 A JOINT RESOLUTION designating the Les Leatherman Memorial Bridge in
2 Laurel County.

3 WHEREAS, Leslie "Les" Roger Leatherman, of London, Kentucky, was a devoted
4 husband, father, grandfather, friend, and public servant; and

5 WHEREAS, Les Leatherman began his career as an emergency medical technician
6 and emergency dispatcher for Laurel County and the Kentucky State Police, and at the
7 time of his death was the assistant director of the 911 center in Whitley County and a fire
8 rescue instructor for the Kentucky Fire Commission; and

9 WHEREAS, Les Leatherman volunteered with the Laurel County Fire Department
10 for 39 years and had risen to the rank of major; and

11 WHEREAS, on May 16, 2025, as a major storm system was moving through
12 southeastern Kentucky, a large tornado touched down in Somerset and began to sweep
13 through three counties. That night, Les Leatherman was dispatched to a fire alarm within
14 its path, and during that call he encountered a tornado touching down; and

15 WHEREAS, on May 17, 2025, Les Leatherman tragically passed away while
16 shielding a woman who turned out to be his wife, Michelle Leatherman, from the historic
17 tornado; and

18 WHEREAS, Les Leatherman is survived by his loving wife Michelle Leatherman;
19 son, Evan (Amber) Leatherman; and his beloved grandchildren, Elias and George; and

20 WHEREAS, the tragic passing of Les Leatherman deeply impacted the community
21 of local emergency responders who looked up to him as a mentor, instructor, and
22 compassionate friend; and

23 WHEREAS, Laurel County officials stated that "Major Leatherman's selfless
24 actions exemplify the highest ideals of public service and sacrifice. His commitment to
25 duty and protection of other, even under the most dangerous conditions, will never be
26 forgotten."; and

27 WHEREAS, Les Leatherman was known for his selfless devotion and unwavering

1 commitment to protecting others, and his ultimate sacrifice will always be remembered
2 by the people of Laurel County and this Commonwealth and should be recognized in a
3 public and tangible way;

4 NOW, THEREFORE,

5 ***Be it resolved by the General Assembly of the Commonwealth of Kentucky:***

6 ➔Section 1. The Transportation Cabinet shall designate the bridge on Kentucky
7 Route 363 in Laurel County, Interstate 75 at mile point 8.03 (Bridge ID #063B00032N),
8 as the "Les Leatherman Memorial Bridge" and shall, within 30 days of the effective date
9 of this Resolution, erect appropriate signage denoting this designation.